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G19 — I wish / If only / It's (high) time / Would rather

Les structures de souhait, regret et préférence

 S4	 B2	 marc.vasseur@polytech-lille.fr
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🔴 Ces structures expriment des souhaits, des regrets ou des préférences que la réalité soit différente. Elles utilisent des temps décalés par rapport à la réalité.

1. I wish / If only

SENS	STRUCTURE	EXEMPLE
Souhait présent irréel	wish / if only + Past Simple	I wish I knew the answer. (mais je ne sais pas)
Regret passé	wish / if only + Past Perfect	I wish I had studied harder. (mais je ne l'ai pas fait)
Irritation / souhait futur	wish / if only + would + V	I wish you would listen! (tu n'écoutes pas)
Wish + were (formel)	wish + were (jamais 'was' formel)	I wish I were taller. (+ soutenu que 'was')

⚠ On peut utiliser 'was' informellement mais 'were' est correct dans tous les contextes.

2. It's (high) time

Structure	Anglais	Note
It's time + to + V	It's time to leave. (neutre — on doit partir)	
It's time + sujet + Past Simple	It's time we left. (léger reproche)	Même si futur → on utilise le prétérit!
It's high time + Past Simple	It's high time you improved your English! (fort reproche)	High time = grand temps — ton critique

3. Would rather / Would sooner

Structure	Anglais	Note
Préférence personnelle	I would rather stay home.	I'd rather + V base (sans to)
Préférence pour autrui	I'd rather you stayed at home.	I'd rather + sujet + Past Simple
Comparaison	I'd rather work here than travel abroad.	I'd rather + V + than + V

 **wish + passé = irréel présent / wish + Past Perfect = regret passé / It's time + prétérit = urgence maintenant.**



EXERCICES GUIDÉS

Complète avec la bonne forme.

Série guidée A — I wish / If only

 souhait présent → prétérit / regret passé → Past Perfect / irritation → would

1. I wish I _____ (know) the answer right now.
→ souhait présent irréel → Past Simple
→ _____
2. She wishes she _____ (study) harder before the exam.
→ regret passé → Past Perfect
→ _____
3. If only it _____ (not / rain) every single day!
→ souhait irréel présent → Past Simple
→ _____
4. I wish you _____ (stop) making so much noise.
→ irritation → would + V base
→ _____
5. He wishes he _____ (be) more confident in presentations.
→ irréel présent → were
→ _____
6. If only they _____ (inform) us earlier about the change.
→ regret passé → Past Perfect
→ _____
7. She wishes she _____ (have) more time to dedicate to research.
→ souhait présent → Past Simple
→ _____
8. I wish the director _____ (be) more open to innovative ideas.
→ irritation → would + V
→ _____
9. If only I _____ (choose) a different career path.
→ regret passé → Past Perfect
→ _____
10. He wishes he _____ (speak) better English at the conference.
→ souhait présent → Past Simple
→ _____

Série guidée B — It's time / Would rather

 it's time + prétérit (même pour le futur!) / would rather + V base

11. It's time we _____ (leave) — the meeting starts in ten minutes.
→ it's time + sujet + prétérit (même sens que le futur)
→ _____
12. It's high time he _____ (stop) procrastinating and start acting.
→ high time + prétérit = fort reproche
→ _____

→ _____

13. I'd rather _____ (work) independently on this particular task.

→ would rather + V base

→ _____

14. I'd rather you _____ (not / mention) this to anyone else.

→ would rather + sujet + prétérit

→ _____

15. It's time _____ (start) taking the language requirement seriously.

→ it's time + to + V (infinitif)

→ _____

16. She would rather _____ (stay) in France than _____ (move) abroad.

→ would rather + V + than + V

→ _____

17. It's high time the company _____ (invest) in modern equipment.

→ high time + prétérit

→ _____

18. I'd rather he _____ (present) the data himself at the board meeting.

→ would rather + sujet + prétérit

→ _____

19. It is about time we _____ (address) this recurring problem.

→ about time + prétérit

→ _____

20. She would sooner _____ (resign) than compromise her professional ethics.

→ would sooner + V base (= would rather)

→ _____



EXERCICES — NIVEAUX A → B2+

Complète les phrases avec la bonne structure.

Niveau A — I wish / If only (B1+)

1. I wish I _____ (be) better at mathematical modelling.
→ _____
2. She wishes she _____ (not / miss) the key conference.
→ _____
3. If only he _____ (arrive) on time for once!
→ _____
4. I wish the weather _____ (change) — this rain is affecting productivity.
→ _____
5. She wishes she _____ (have) more relevant professional experience.
→ _____

Niveau B — It's time / Would rather (B2)

6. It's time we _____ (address) this problem seriously.
→ _____
7. He wishes his team _____ (be) more self-motivated.
→ _____
8. I'd rather _____ (not / work) overtime this particular week.
→ _____
9. It's high time they _____ (update) the outdated software.
→ _____
10. If only I _____ (know) about this issue earlier!
→ _____
11. I wish he _____ (listen) when I give professional advice.
→ _____
12. She wishes she _____ (choose) a different research specialisation.
→ _____
13. It's time you _____ (take) full responsibility for your actions.
→ _____
14. I'd rather he _____ (present) the results himself at the conference.
→ _____
15. If only we _____ (have) more time to prepare thoroughly.
→ _____

Niveau C — Erreurs et traduction (B2)

→ Corrige les erreurs.

16. I wish I know the answer. → _____
→ _____
17. If only she would have told me earlier! → _____
→ _____
18. It's time we leave — the taxi is waiting. → _____
→ _____
19. I'd rather to work alone on this task. → _____
→ _____

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→ _____

20. She wishes she didn't accepted that position. → _____

→ _____

→ Traduis en anglais.

21. Je regrette de ne pas avoir appris le japonais quand j'en avais l'occasion.

→ _____

22. Il serait grand temps qu'ils investissent dans de nouveaux équipements.

→ _____

23. Elle préférerait travailler à Lyon plutôt que de déménager à Paris.

→ _____

24. Si seulement il avait vérifié ses calculs avant de soumettre le rapport !

→ _____

25. Il est temps de reconsidérer sérieusement notre approche.

→ _____

Score : _____ / 25 points

★ ★ Bonus — Nuances entre wish et hope

Complète avec wish ou hope + la bonne forme.

→ I _____ the results will be positive. (expectation realistic)

Réponse : _____

→ I _____ the results were different. (irréel présent)

Réponse : _____

→ She _____ she could attend. (souhait irréel — elle ne peut pas)

Réponse : _____

→ She _____ she can attend. (possibilité réelle future)

Réponse : _____

→ We _____ the project succeeds — we've worked so hard.

Réponse : _____

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DEVOIR MAISON

Nom & Prénom : _____

Groupe : _____

Date rendu : _____



Complète avec la bonne structure.



Correction envoyée via WhatsApp la semaine prochaine.

1. I wish I _____ (speak) perfect English — it would open so many doors.

→ _____

2. She wishes she _____ (not / accept) that position — it was a mistake.

→ _____

3. If only he _____ (call) me before making that decision!

→ _____

4. It's high time you _____ (improve) your academic writing skills.

→ _____

5. I'd rather _____ (stay) here than travel to the conference tomorrow.

→ _____

6. I wish the director _____ (be) more open-minded about new proposals.

→ _____

7. It's time we _____ (have) a serious conversation about the project timeline.

→ _____

8. She wishes she _____ (study) abroad when she had the opportunity.

→ _____

9. I'd rather he _____ (not / share) confidential data with external partners.

→ _____

10. If only I _____ (know) about this technical problem earlier!

→ _____

11. It's high time the team _____ (adopt) more efficient working practices.

→ _____

12. She would sooner _____ (resign) than be asked to falsify data.

→ _____

13. I wish you _____ (stop) interrupting me during presentations.

→ _____

14. If only we _____ (prepare) more thoroughly for the demonstration.

→ _____

15. It is about time the institution _____ (recognise) his exceptional contribution.

→ _____

Score : _____ / 15 points